



Expense Log Bot

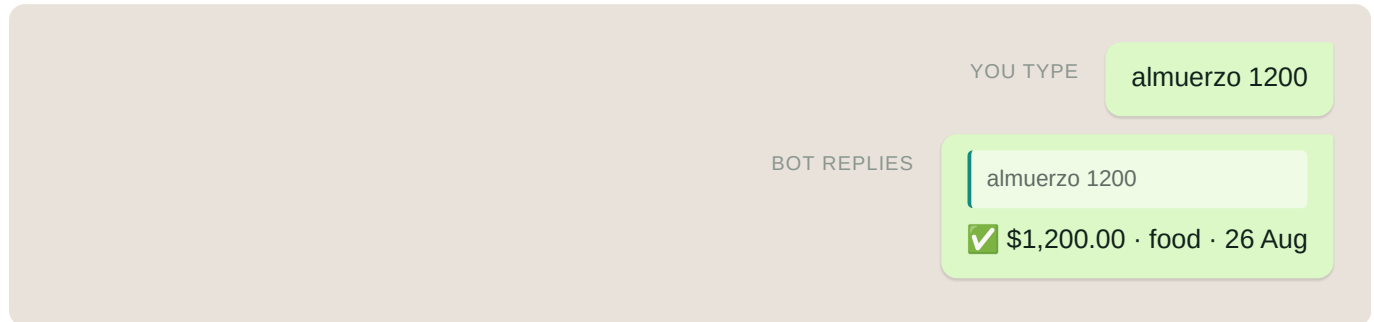
Track what you spend by texting yourself on WhatsApp.

Send a message like **almuerzo 1200** and it appears in your Google Sheet within seconds — amount, currency, category and date, sorted out for you. No app to open, no form to fill in.

How it works

You already know the interface. It is your own WhatsApp chat.

The bot listens to **one chat only**: the conversation you have with yourself. Open WhatsApp, search your own name, and pick “**Message yourself**”. Anything you type there is read, understood and filed. Nothing else on your phone is touched, and nobody else can send anything to the bot.



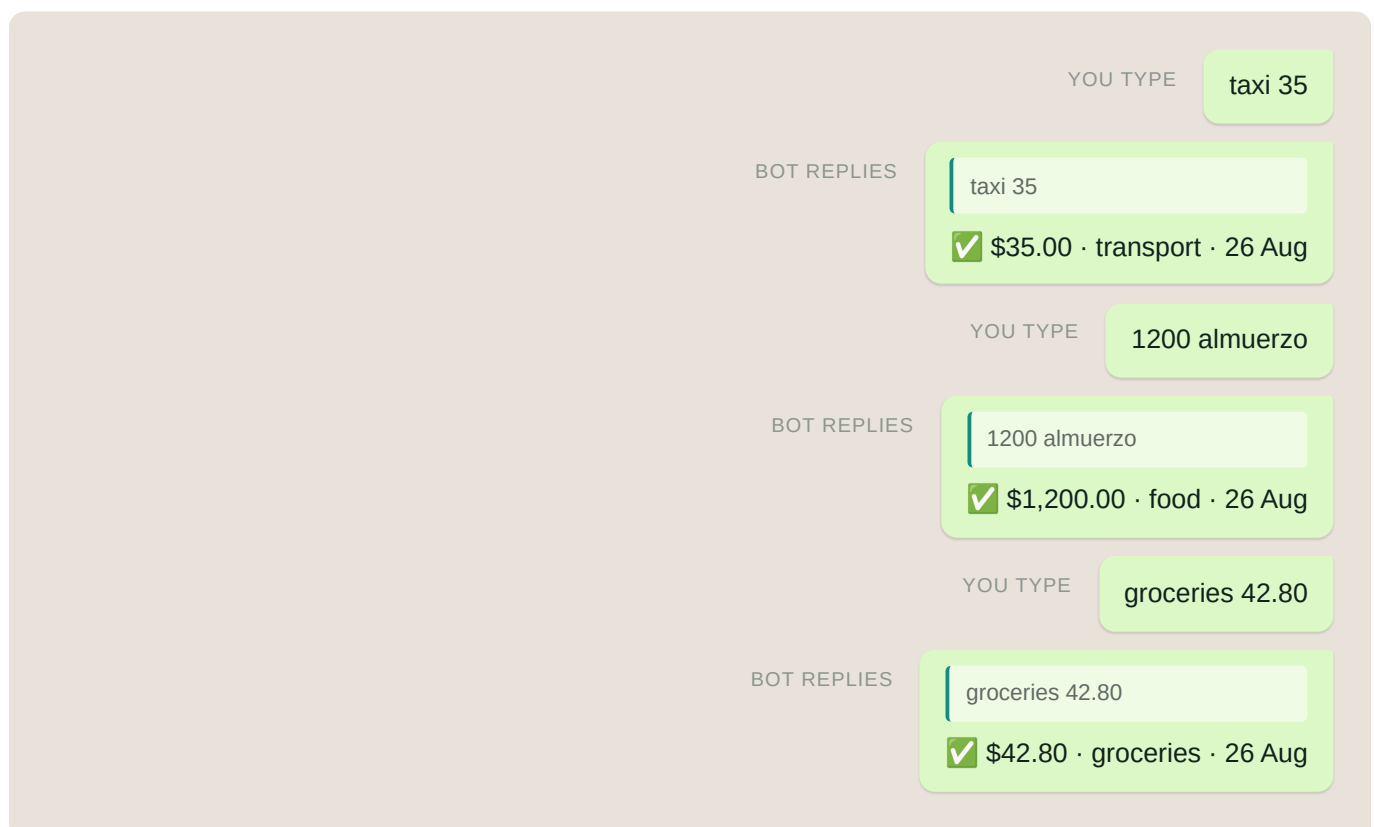
The screenshot shows a WhatsApp chat interface. On the right, under the heading "YOU TYPE", there is a green message bubble containing the text "almuerzo 1200". On the left, under the heading "BOT REPLIES", there is a green message bubble. This bubble contains a quoted block with the text "almuerzo 1200" and a green checkmark followed by the text "\$1,200.00 · food · 26 Aug".

Both are green. Because the bot writes into your own chat, its replies look exactly like your messages — same colour, same side. The way to tell them apart is the small quoted block: every bot reply quotes the message it is answering. Your own messages never do.

That green tick is the important part. It is sent **only after** the row is safely saved in your spreadsheet. If you see a tick, the expense is recorded. If something went wrong, the bot says so in plain words instead.

Writing an expense

Write the way you would in a notebook. A description and a number, in either order.



The screenshot shows a WhatsApp chat interface with three examples of messages and replies. Each example consists of a "YOU TYPE" bubble on the right and a "BOT REPLIES" bubble on the left. The first example shows "taxi 35" being typed, with the bot replying with a quoted block "taxi 35" and a green checkmark followed by "\$35.00 · transport · 26 Aug". The second example shows "1200 almuerzo" being typed, with the bot replying with a quoted block "1200 almuerzo" and a green checkmark followed by "\$1,200.00 · food · 26 Aug". The third example shows "groceries 42.80" being typed, with the bot replying with a quoted block "groceries 42.80" and a green checkmark followed by "\$42.80 · groceries · 26 Aug".

Other currencies

Amounts default to your configured currency. Add a symbol to override it for that one entry.

YOU TYPE	RECORDED AS
\$18 lunch	\$18.00 · food
¥480 coffee	¥480 · food – yen has no decimals
€40 groceries	€40.00 · groceries

Dates — including yesterday

With no date, the bot uses today. Say when it happened and it works out the real date, in whatever language you are writing in.

YOU TYPE	DATE RECORDED
taxi 35 yesterday	the day before today
almuerzo 20 ayer	the day before today
コーヒー 480 昨日	the day before today
dinner 30 on aug 20	20 August

Several things in one message

Separate them with **and** or with commas. Each becomes its own row.

YOU TYPE

lunch 15, coffee 4, bus 2

BOT REPLIES

lunch 15, coffee 4, bus 2

✓ \$15.00 · food · 26 Aug

✓ \$4.00 · food · 26 Aug

✓ \$2.00 · transport · 26 Aug

Categories

You never type a category. The bot chooses one and learns from you.

Each expense is filed under a category so your monthly totals mean something. The bot reads the categories already in your sheet and reuses them wherever it can. When something genuinely new comes along, it creates a category for it.

YOU TYPE	FILED UNDER	
lunch 12	food	reused an existing one
pharmacy 22	health	reused
electric bill 85	bills	reused
uber 24 to airport	transport	reused
rent 900	rent	new category created
vet for the dog 65	pets	new category created

You are in charge of the list. The categories live in your spreadsheet, not inside the bot. Rename a category in the sheet and the bot follows it from then on. If you would rather it stopped inventing new ones, tidy the column and it will stick to what it finds.

When the bot asks a question

If it cannot tell how much something cost, it asks rather than guessing. Reply with just the number and it remembers what you were talking about.

The screenshot illustrates the bot's behavior when it needs more information. It shows a chat window with a light beige background. The first interaction shows the user typing 'coffee' in a green bubble. The bot's response, in a light green bubble, shows 'coffee' in a text input field and a red question mark followed by the text 'How much was the coffee?'. The second interaction shows the user typing '480' in a green bubble. The bot's response, in a light green bubble, shows '480' in a text input field and a green checkmark followed by the text '\$480.00 · food · 26 Aug'.

A message with no expense in it is simply ignored, with a note so you know it was seen and not silently swallowed.

Commands

Five words worth remembering.

COMMAND	WHAT IT DOES
undo	Removes everything the last message added. If that message logged three expenses, all three go. Tells you exactly what it removed.
total	This month's spending, with a breakdown per category, largest first.
total food	This month for one category. Works with any category in your sheet.
clean	Empties the sheet completely, keeping the column headings. A backup file is saved first, and your spreadsheet's own version history is a second safety net.
help	A short reminder of the above, plus the categories currently in use.

YOU TYPE

total

BOT REPLIES

total

 Aug 2026
 \$1,412.00 · 3 entries
 food — \$1,200.00
 transport — \$200.00
 bills — \$12.00

YOU TYPE

undo

BOT REPLIES

undo

 Removed 1 row.
 \$200.00 · transport

Totals are not converted between currencies. If you log in both dollars and yen, each is totalled separately and shown side by side. The bot will not invent an exchange rate for you.

What lands in your spreadsheet

One row per expense, seven columns.

COLUMN	CONTAINS	EXAMPLE
timestamp	When the row was written	2026-08-26T23:23:22+09:00
date	When the money was spent	08-25-2026
amount	A real number, so SUM works	35
currency	Three-letter code	USD
category	Chosen by the bot	transport
description	Short, in your own language	taxi
raw_message	Exactly what you typed	taxi 35 yesterday

Why the last column matters. If the bot ever files something oddly, the original wording is right there next to it. You can correct the row by hand and see immediately what it was working from. The sheet is yours — edit any cell at any time. The bot reads it back the next time you ask for a total.

If something goes wrong

The bot tells you plainly. It never pretends a failed save worked.

MESSAGE	WHAT IT MEANS	WHAT TO DO
⚠ Sheet write failed...	Google Sheets was unreachable. Your expense was saved on the server and is queued.	Nothing. It is retried automatically every minute.
⚠ Could not reach the parser...	The language service was briefly unavailable. Nothing was recorded.	Send the message again in a moment.
😞 No expense found...	No amount could be found in the message.	Include a number, or send help.
No reply at all	The service is not running.	Contact whoever administers the bot.

A tick always means saved. The confirmation is sent after the write succeeds, never before, so you can trust it. Anything short of a tick means the expense is either queued or not recorded, and the message says which.

Good to know

Dates follow one timezone

“Yesterday” is worked out in the timezone the bot is configured for, not your phone’s. It matters only if you log around midnight while travelling.

Only you can use it

The bot answers messages you send in your own chat and ignores everything else. Nobody can add rows to your sheet by messaging you.

Correct anything by hand

Wrong category or amount? Edit the cell in the spreadsheet. Nothing in the bot needs changing, and totals update immediately.

Not included

Photographs of receipts, voice notes, budgets, recurring expenses and currency conversion are outside what this bot does.

A one-minute start

- Open WhatsApp and go to the chat with yourself.
- Send `help` — the bot replies with what it understands.
- Send a real expense, for example `coffee 4.50`.
- Look at your spreadsheet. The row is already there.
- Send `total` at the end of the day.